

Summit Vale engagement standards

The common commitments that govern how we frame, deliver and close engagements.

AUDIENCE	All Summit Vale Advisory team members and approved collaborators
PURPOSE	Set a shared baseline for reliable, respectful and decision-useful client work.
VERSION	1.0 As of 13 Jul 2026
OWNER	Keiko Ward Engagement Operations

Our commitments

Be clear about the decision. Be rigorous with facts. Protect entrusted information. Make ownership visible. Surface uncertainty early. Leave the client with a usable path forward.

Engagement lifecycle

- Mobilize: confirm scope, roles, governance and access.
- Diagnose: maintain hypotheses, evidence logs and review gates.
- Design: make trade-offs explicit and test feasibility.
- Deliver: obtain accountable approval and package handoff materials.
- Close: archive appropriately, capture lessons and complete access changes.

Control record: minimum evidence for a review

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Application notes

Worked example: Client Alpha

Synthetic example data. For Client Alpha Phase 1 Finance, the JPY 42.8M approved diagnostic budget is recorded in the scope baseline. Avery Calder owns engagement governance, Nina Solberg owns quality review, Theo Mercer owns finance method and Keiko Ward owns information handling.

Professional conduct

Do not overstate certainty, reuse client material outside its permitted purpose, or allow urgency to obscure review. Raise concerns early through the engagement lead. Constructive challenge is an expected delivery behavior.

Decision worksheet

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Practice note. Use concise records that make the next decision easier. This guide is an internal operating reference; it is not a substitute for engagement-specific governance.

Execution and review

Minimum engagement record

Maintain scope and decision log, stakeholder map, evidence/assumption log, risk log, quality-gate record, deliverable register and closeout record. Keep records concise, current and accessible to authorized team members.

Practical checklist

- Confirm the purpose and audience before working from the guide.
- Maintain clear distinction between verified facts, assumptions and synthetic examples.
- Record accountable owner, next step and decision date.
- Invite an independent reviewer when conclusions or access risks are material.
- Update the engagement record after the decision is made.

Sign-off prompts

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
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Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Summit Vale Advisory | Internal reference guide | As of 13 Jul 2026 | Owner: Avery Calder, Engagement Excellence